A FREE MEDICAID PLANNING ROADMAP OVERVIEW · NEED CARE NOW

YOU ARE HERE Step 7 of 9, Apply · 7.1 Medicaid Application Next: 8.1 Asset Protection

Where You Are: The Application Step, Who Does Which Part, and What Comes After It

The nine steps of the Medicaid Planning Roadmap, with yours marked.

When Mom needs care now, the Medicaid application can feel like the whole job, and like yours alone. It is one step of nine, and there is more than one pair of hands on it.

This page shows the whole road, where you are on it, who does which part of this step, and what comes after it.

Phase 1 · Assess

Understand where you are today.

1 **Understand** Care Needs → Levels of Care & Costs → Care Plan
You finish with: Immediate Care Needs Assessment

2 **Organize** Income & Assets → Ownership & Expenses → Financial File
You finish with: Financial Snapshot & Care Cost Analysis

3 **Assess** Care & Nonfinancial Eligibility → Income & Assets → Barriers & Readiness
You finish with: Medicaid Readiness Assessment

Phase 2 · Plan

Develop and implement your strategy.

4 **Plan** Barriers & Issues → Priorities & Professional Team → Written Plan
You finish with: Medicaid Action Plan

5 **Legal** Authority & Documents → Property, Trusts & Transfers → Attorney Review
You finish with: Legal Issues & Attorney Review Brief

6 **Financial** Costs & Runway → Asset Treatment & Tools → Strategy & Documentation
You finish with: Financial Strategy & Implementation Plan

Phase 3 · Secure

Secure benefits, protect assets, and maintain eligibility.

7 **Apply** Prepare → Submit → Manage
You finish with: Medicaid Application File

You are here. This step is about Mom's Medicaid application: preparing it, submitting it, and managing what comes back. It is done when the application has been submitted, supported, tracked and taken through a determination, with the record of all of it in one file.

8 **Protect** What May Be Protected → What May Remain Exposed → What Needs Ongoing Attention
You finish with: Asset Protection Report

9 **Maintain** Ongoing Requirements → Changes & Renewals → Maintenance System
You finish with: Medicaid Maintenance Plan

What this step produces

A Medicaid Application File: the completed application, the supporting documents, the record of what was submitted, the dates to keep track of, the requests still open, and where the application stands.

The application itself goes to the Medicaid agency in Mom's state. States operate Medicaid day to day, including taking applications and making determinations of eligibility. [1]

The file is an organized record. It isn't the decision, and having one doesn't mean Mom is approved.

Who does which part, by role

- You and your family: gathering the records, listing what hasn't turned up, keeping one log of what has been sent and asked for, and passing on every letter.
- Mom: what she knows and remembers about her own accounts and papers, if she's able to tell you.
- The rehab's or facility's social worker or business office: the care and facility paperwork, such as admission papers and bills.
- Your Medicaid planner: confirms the Medicaid program, where and how to apply, and the target application date with you; then tracks the correspondence, the dates and any requests for additional information through to the determination.
- An applications specialist: assembles the application file, checks the answers against the supporting documents, and submits the application.
- The Medicaid agency in Mom's state: takes the application and makes the determination.
- An elder law attorney: the legal issues, if any come up. Your Medicaid planner refers those on.

What comes after it

The step ends with a determination, and the determination arrives by letter. The federal long-term care site says an approval letter gives the date of eligibility and the amount the person must pay toward the cost of their care, and a denial letter explains the reason and how to appeal. [1]

Either letter is something to go through with your Medicaid planner. A legal question goes to an elder law attorney; among the things the same site says elder law attorneys do is exploring a person's qualifications for Medicaid and, if appropriate, applying on their behalf. [2]

Then come the last two steps. Step eight, Protect, looks at what may be protected, what may remain exposed and what needs ongoing attention. Step nine, Maintain, covers the ongoing requirements, changes and renewals.

What this page doesn't promise

How long any part takes, who will be available, or how the application turns out. It doesn't say Mom will qualify for anything or that any amount will be protected, and it isn't legal, financial or tax advice. Families move through the steps at different speeds.

Ready for the next step?

You know where the application sits, who does which part of it and what follows. The planning interview is the next thing to do from here: it asks about your family's situation and gives you a free planning report you can bring to any conversation about paying for care.

Get Your Free Planning Report ›

WHERE THIS COMES FROM

The nine steps and the roles are the Medicaid Planning Roadmap's own. That states take applications and make the determinations, what the decision letters contain, and the description of what elder law attorneys do come from the federal long-term care site.

1. Administration for Community Living (LongTermCare.gov), Applying for Medicaid
2. Administration for Community Living (LongTermCare.gov), Will I Need a Lawyer?

From the Medicaid Planning Roadmap · Richard Ladson, Certified Medicaid Planner. Draft for review, generated 2026-10-04.